



Activation Process Guidelines

Marine Rescue Queensland

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Document Identification

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Revision History

Version	Release authority	Details	Date

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Name	Title	Details	Date

1. Before Activation – Start a trip in OffshoreSMS

1.1. Start Trip: Scheduled vessel checks and pre-departure risk assessments

For a busy unit with multiple call outs expected for the day, it is suggested that the master performs a scheduled vessel check early and pre-departure risk assessment in the morning and start the trip with no crew. Once the first activation is confirmed, add the crew so the sea time calculation starts in OffshoreSMS.

[Please see detailed quick reference guide below – Appendix 1](#)

1.2. Unscheduled vessel checks and pre-departure risk assessments

For call outs midnight or on a less busy day, the vessel master should perform an unscheduled vessel check, and pre-departure risk assessments just before leaving the docks, same process as above, except for the crew manifest section. Please populate the crew manifest as you expect to leave dock the moment the vessel and pre-departure risk assessments are completed.

2. Activations received and in progress

2.1. Radio operator/duty officer or Vessel Master received the request

After Radio operators/duty officers or Vessel Master receive the request for activation (via phone, radio or other channels), he/she should create an activation in ActivateMRQ, and populate as many fields as possible on the distress vessel and the target location fields in the problem section, see quick reference guide below

[Please see detailed quick reference guide below – Appendix 2](#)

2.2. Vessel master receives the activation details

There are two options that a master can receive the drafted activation details:

1. Radio Operator can print a paper-based activation form and give to the Vessel Master;
2. Radio Operator can inform vessel master the activation ID via Radio, and vessel master can open the ActivateMRQ app on their vessel iPad and check the activation details based on the ID electronically.

Radio operator/duty officer can continue updating the activation details and vessel master should be able to see those updates on the vessel iPad instantly, if the iPad is within 4G/5G coverage.

2.3. Dynamic risk assessment and ship's log

Once on the water, the vessel master should continuously perform dynamic risk assessment, and any changes of situation that has led a change of decision should be recorded as ship logs in OffshoreSMS

We suggest two forms of ship logs:

1. Location pin drop (OffshoreSMS Weather Assessment) which indicates a location change, and will automatically record the latest sea states once pin drop is confirmed
2. A voice over text to describe in plain English what situation has changed that could change the risk factors, and any decision change because of that

[Please see detailed quick reference guide below – Appendix 3](#)

2.4. Ship's log for multiple activations

If there are multiple activations in a trip, vessel master can receive new activation details and ID via Radio and check the details (Distress vessel information and target location) on ActivateMRQ via vessel iPad and continuously record ship's log and dynamic risk assessments.

Every new activation should prompt the master to drop a new pin in OffshoreSMS for updating the sea states and continue recording voice over text to describe the nature of the new mission and any risk factor changes.

3. Activations Completed

3.1. Trip completed

Once the trip is over and back to the base, vessel master can perform the shutdown checks and close the trip on OffshoreSMS. See quick reference guide below

[Please see detailed quick reference guide below – Appendix 4](#)

3.2. Activation debriefs and finalisation

After vessel master rest up, debrief, he/she can finalise the ongoing activation forms in ActivateMRQ, fields such as:

1. Services rendered, Tow to
2. Master, Crew, special persons on board
3. Any updates on the distress vessel and target location information
4. Operational statistics such as engine hours, fuel consumption

Master then changes the activation status to finalised and save, see quick reference guide

[Please see detailed quick reference guide below – Appendix 5](#)

Appendix 1

New Trip Start Up

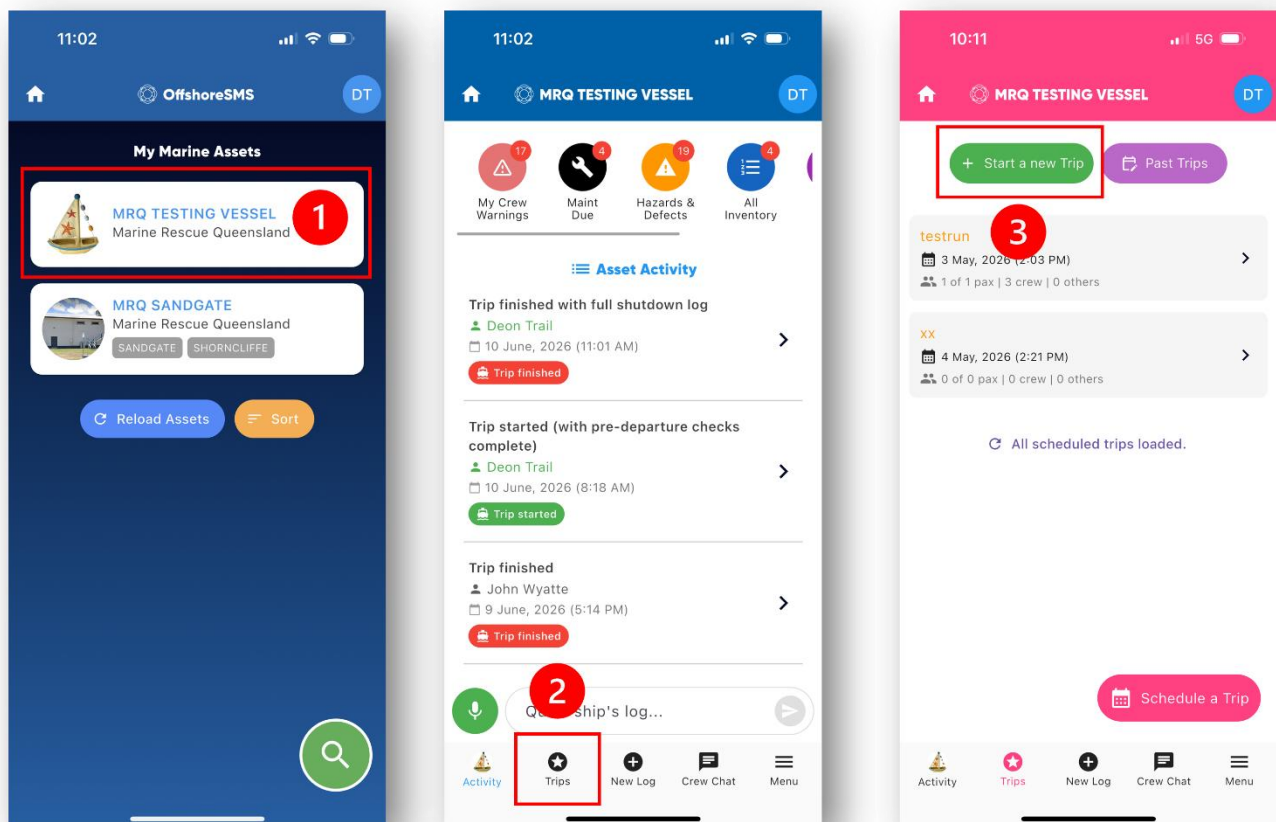
KEY POINTS: This pre-operating check, required by Marine Order 504, ensures the vessel's readiness by documenting any issues and verifying vessel status before departure. During these pre-departure checks, the Vessel Master can document any vessel defects or hazards directly.

After verifying crew, vessel Master and other persons onboard, setting departure and return times, tagging the trip, and confirming fuel and equipment data, the Start Up Log is completed, marking the vessel seaworthy and ready for operation.

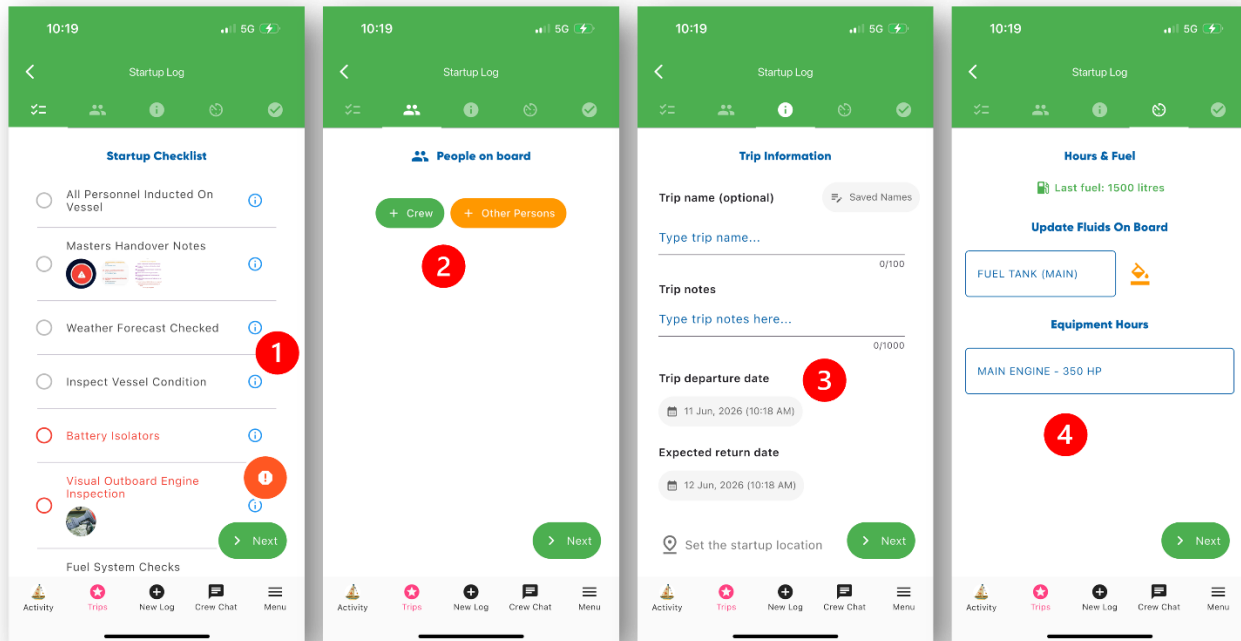
RESPONSIBILITY: This functionality in OffshoreSMS is **only** available to **Vessel Master's** and **Unit administration**.

NAVIGATION

1. Vessel >> Trip icon (bottom navigation menu) >> Start a new Trip



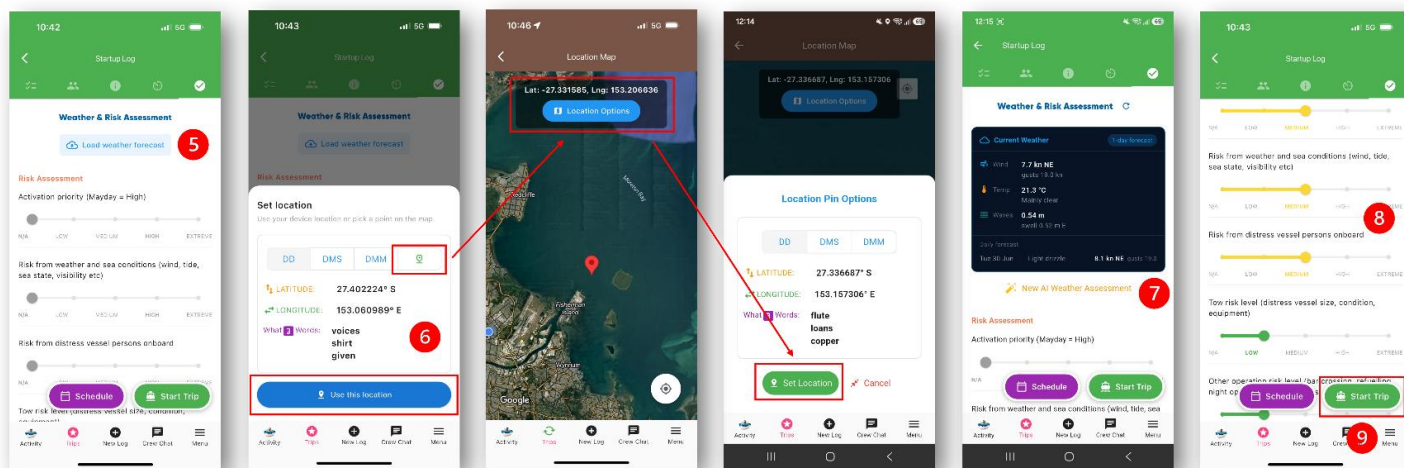
PROCESS FLOW (The screenshots below are from a mobile phone, there may be a slight difference if they are accessed via a tablet styled device).



STEPS

1. In the Startup Checklist, select the radio button beside the items that have been checked (it will change to a tick icon). **Important note:** This is a legal document, only confirm components of the checklist that have actually been checked.
2. Click on the + **Crew** button to add crew and + Other Persons button for Other Persons. **Note:** If there are Crew warning **you must accept the warnings** or **rectify them** prior to departure
3. Tag the trip by giving it a **name**, this will assist with searching for it later, if logs need to be added post trip shut down and add the expected departure and return date and time.
4. Add any other relevant Trip information, including fuel and engine hours information.

Continue over the page



STEPS

5. Select the **Load weather forecast** button to add forecast to the start-up log
6. Select the **Use this location** button to retrieve weather information **for your current location**. Or if you want to use a different location.
 - a. Select the **Drop Pin icon** to use the chart to select a location to retrieve the weather for,
 - b. Then select the **Location Options** button and,
 - c. Then **Set Location**.
7. **Note:** this will load **Wind, Temp and Wave** information into the Trip log **automatically** for the location selected.
8. Move each of the **slider bars** to complete the initial Risk Assessment for the Trip. **Note:** *if the trip is not part of an activation, you do not need to use that slider.*
9. Click on the **Start Trip** button. **Note** – if the button shows **Finish Checks**, this indicates that some of the mandatory start up items have not been completed.

The Trip is now active, select on the **New Log** icon (bottom navigation menu) or the **Quick Ships Log** (voice to text) to add logs to the Trip or select the **Green Active Trip** to access the trip and view logs or add logs via the **Log an Activity** button.

NOTES: It is **important** to ensure that you have checked current **vessel alerts** before you start a trip.

You can check the vessel alerts (Crew, Maintenance, Hazards or Defects) through the **icons** in the top navigation menu of the vessel screen.

Appendix 2

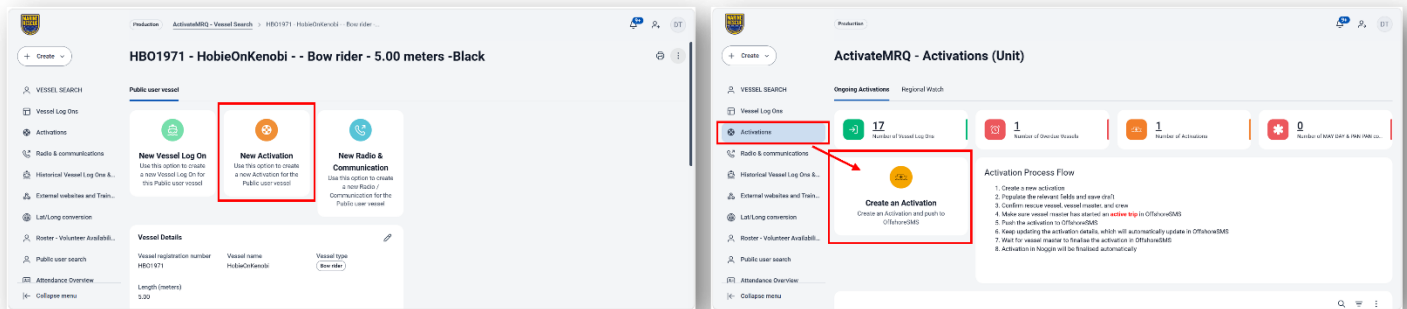
Create an Activation – Vessel Master, Duty Officer or Radio Operator

The activation form is separated into the following sections:

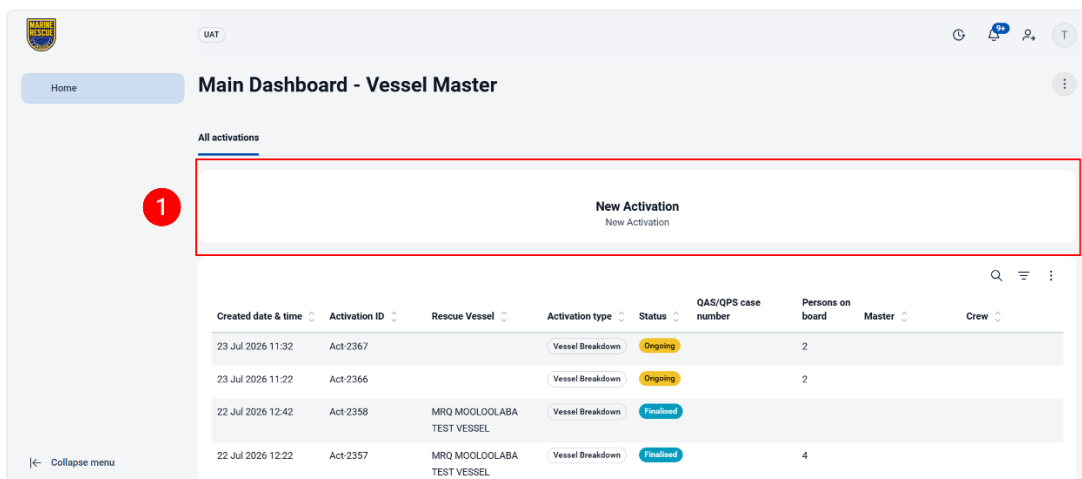
- Date, Time, Activation Source & Informant Contact
- Problem
- Distressed Vessel Information
- Team
- Operational Statistics

Steps to Create a New Activation

1. **For Radio Operators** - Select the **New Activation** tile for an **existing vessel** or the **Create an Activate** tile for a new vessel **not on the system**.



For Vessel Masters – In the Vessel master profile, select the **New Activation** tile.



OFFICIAL

- The Date and Time are auto generated. Add the **Informant contact number** if it is provided as it may be different to the onboard contact, then select the activation source and then radio channel being utilised.

The screenshot shows the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. On the right, the 'New Activation' form is open. A red box highlights the following fields: 'Date & time Received' (21 Jul 2026 09:42), 'Date & time finalised' (Date & time), 'Status' (Ongoing), 'Onboard Contact Number' (Phone number), 'Activation Source' (Radio), and 'Radio Channel' (Select your option). A red circle with the number '2' is positioned next to the 'Status' field.

- Add all the information regarding the **Problem** (activation situation) that has been provided.

The screenshot shows the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. On the right, the 'New Activation' form is open. A red box highlights the 'Problem' section, which includes the following fields: 'Related Trip' (Select object), 'Activation Type' (Vessel Breakdown), 'Location list' (Select object), 'Latitude (degrees)' (Number), 'Latitude (minutes)' (Number), 'Longitude (Degrees)' (Number), 'Longitude (minutes)' (Number), 'Are they anchored?' (Select your option), 'QAS/QPS Details' (Single-line text), 'Assistance Requested' (Select your option), 'Tow To' (Select object), and 'Any details about distress vessel and activation information' (Multi-line text). A red circle with the number '3' is positioned next to the 'Problem' section header.

OFFICIAL

4. Search for the vessel or trip based on the information provided. **NOTE:** The fields of Distress vessel section will be auto populated after the activation is "**Saved**", if an existing vessel is selected from the database, or the related trip is selected.
 - a. If the vessel is not located in the system, add all the information regarding the **Distressed Vessel** that has been provided.

UAT

Home

Main Dashboard - Vessel Master

All activations

Created date & time	Activation ID	Rescue Vessel	Activation type	Status
23 Jul 2026 13:58	Act-2370		Vessel Breakdown	On
23 Jul 2026 11:32	Act-2367		Vessel Breakdown	On
23 Jul 2026 11:22	Act-2366		Vessel Breakdown	On
22 Jul 2026 12:42	Act-2358	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	On

New Activation

Cancel New Activation Save

Distressed Vessel Information

Persons on board: Number

Is any person injured?: Select your option

Are they anchored?: Select your option

Related Trip: Select object

Distress Vessel Selected from Existing Database: Search by call sign, mobile number, re

Below fields of Distress vessel section will be auto populated after "Save", if an existing vessel is selected from the database, or the related trip is selected

Boat Name / Call Sign: Boat name/ call sign

Vessel Registration: Single-line text

Distressed Vessel Skipper: Single-line text

Onboard Contact Number: +61 format

☐ Vsheet displayed and life jacket worn?

5. Add all the information regarding the **Team** (Rescue Vessel, Master, Crew).

UAT

Home

Main Dashboard - Vessel Master

Ongoing Historical

Activation ID	Rescue Vessel	Activation type	QAS/QPS ca
Act-2326	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	
Act-2301	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	
Act-2282	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL		
Act-2224	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL		
Act-2223	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL		

New Activation

Cancel New Activation Save

Team

Unit: Select object

Rescue Vessel: Select object

Master: +

Crew: +

Select object

Select object

Operational Statistics

Offshore Operations?: Select your option

Night Operations?: Select your option

Fuel Consumption: Number

Distance Travelled: Number

Sea State: Select your option

Engine hours: Number

6. **Operational information** can also be added in this section of the form.
7. Once the information available has been entered, select the **Save** button.

The screenshot displays the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. On the left, there is a sidebar with a 'Home' button and a 'Collapse menu' option. The main area shows a table of ongoing activations with columns for 'Activation ID', 'Rescue Vessel', 'Activation type', and 'QAS/QPS call'. The table lists several activations, all with the vessel 'MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL' and the type 'Vessel Breakdown'. On the right, the 'New Activation' form is open. It has a 'Cancel' button and a 'Save' button (highlighted with a red circle and the number 7). The form is divided into two main sections: 'Team' and 'Operational Statistics'. The 'Team' section includes fields for 'Unit', 'Rescue Vessel', 'Master', and 'Crew', each with a 'Select object' button. The 'Operational Statistics' section (highlighted with a red circle and the number 6) includes fields for 'Offshore Operations?', 'Night Operations?', 'Fuel Consumption', 'Distance Travelled', 'Sea State', and 'Engine hours', each with a 'Select your option' or 'Number' input field.

Once the activation is saved it will be added to the list in the Ongoing Activations list and an activation number is auto generated.

Note: This auto generated number should be added to the Ships log, so there is a reference for it in OffshoreSMS.

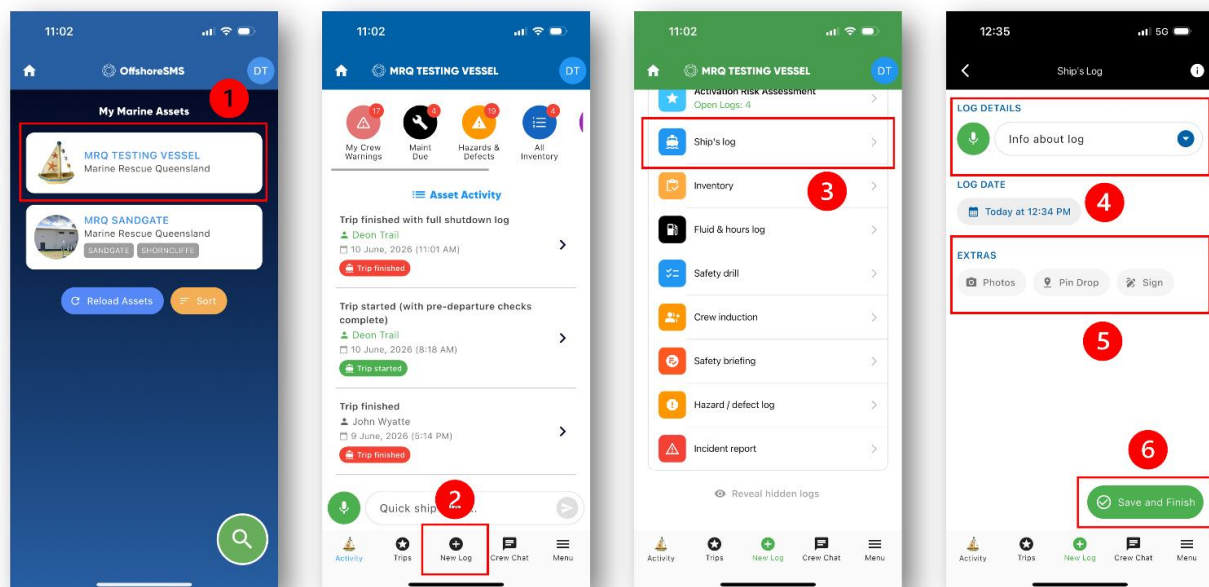
Appendix 3

During Trip Ships Log

KEY POINTS: Whether you need to capture VHF radio communications, navigation notes, vessel movements, or anything else relevant to the voyage, adding entries to the Ship's Log is essential for documenting all vessel activities during a voyage or trip.

RESPONSIBILITY: This functionality in OffshoreSMS is available to Vessel Master.

STEPS/NAVIGATION



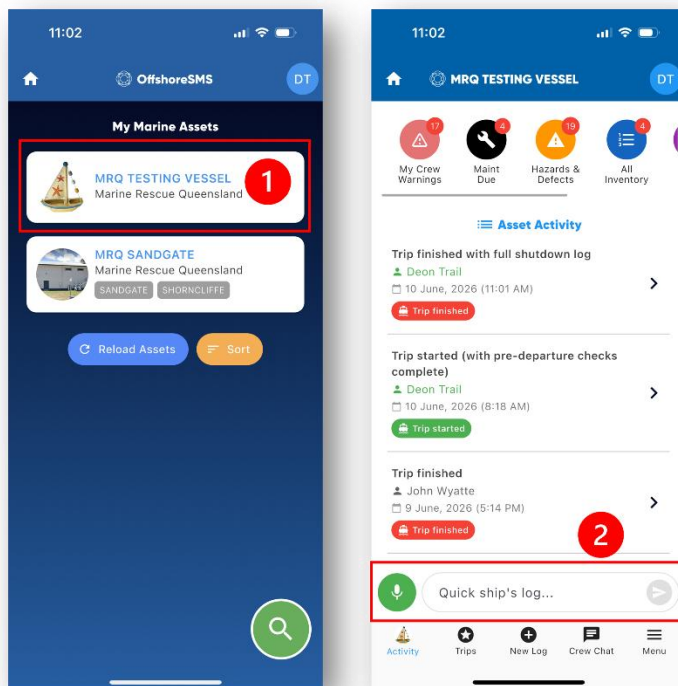
1. Select the **Vessel**
2. **New Log**
3. **Ship's Log: Please note** - the list of logs you can view will be dependent on your unit's preference, if the log you require is not listed, select the '**Reveal Hidden Logs**' button to show all logs available).
4. Manually type in the Ship Log
5. Or select the **microphone icon** and record voice to text.
6. Add Photos, a Pin Drop location and/or Signatures for the Ships Log.
7. Select **Save and Finish**, to complete the log.

PROCESS FLOW (The screenshots below are from a mobile phone, there may be a slight difference if they are accessed via a tablet styled device).

IMPORTANT NOTE: As a ships log is a legal document, only the **author** can edit log entries after they have been saved. Alternatively, if there is an entry made that needs to be rectified, a **superseding entry** can be made to note the **new information** and explain the last log is not relevant.

QUICK SHIPS LOG - NAVIGATION

1. Vessel >> Microphone icon (record voice to text)

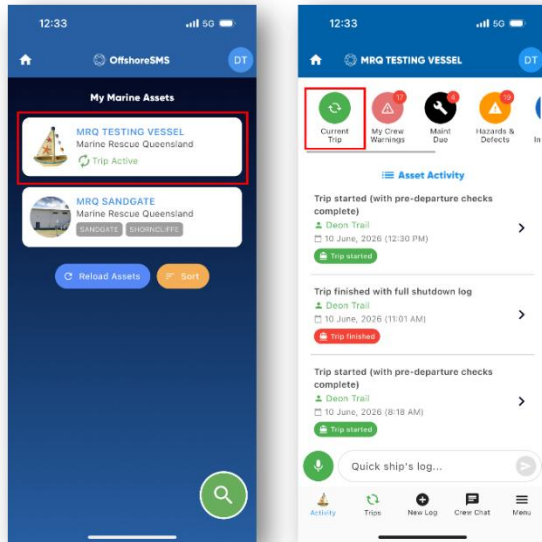


Ship's Log v's Quick Ship Log – If there is no need/requirement for photos, pin drop location or signature associated with the ship's log, then the **Quick Ship Log** is the **quicker** way to record a ship's log in OffshoreSMS.

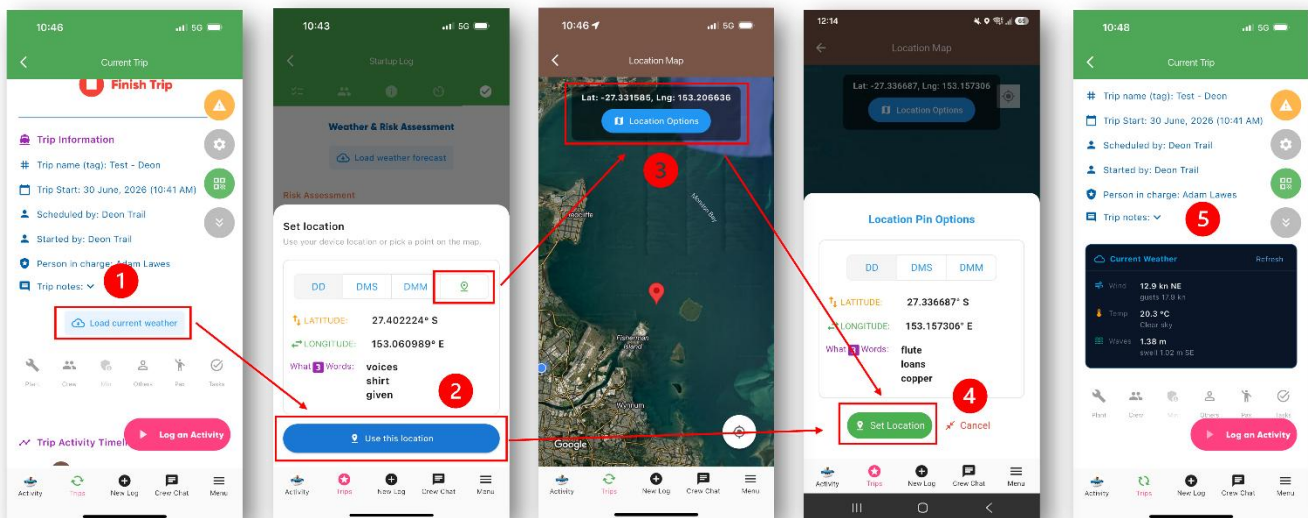
The Quick Ship Log feature enables you to speak your notes, review/edit the text, and log them instantly, or save them for later entry. This is especially useful when you're out to sea and bouncing around or just anytime you need to be focused on other matters.

NEW LOCATION AND WEATHER - NAVIGATION

1. Vessel with Trip Active
2. **Current Trip** icon in the Top menu.



STEPS

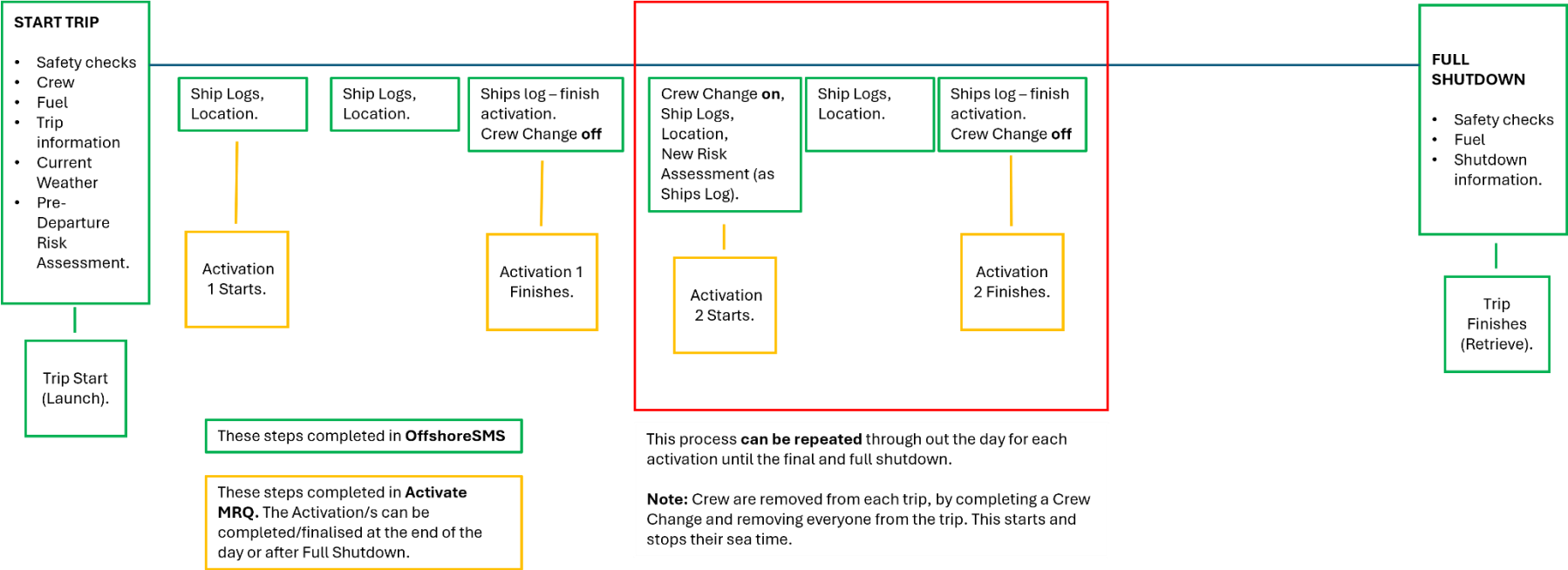


1. Select the **Load weather forecast** button to add forecast to the start-up log
2. Select the **Use this location** button to retrieve weather information for **your current location**.
3. Select the **Drop Pin** icon to use the map to select a location to retrieve the weather for,
4. Then select the **Location Options** button and,
5. Then **Set Location**.

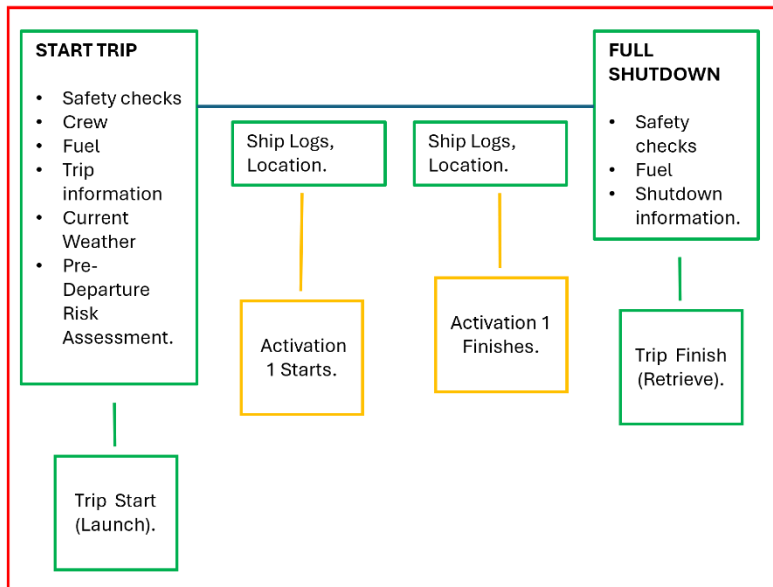
Note: this will load **Wind, Temp and Wave** information into the Trip log **automatically** for the location selected.

TRIP TIMELINE EXAMPLES

Multiple activations per day with single full start up and full shut down each day (e.g. Rostered Crew Day).

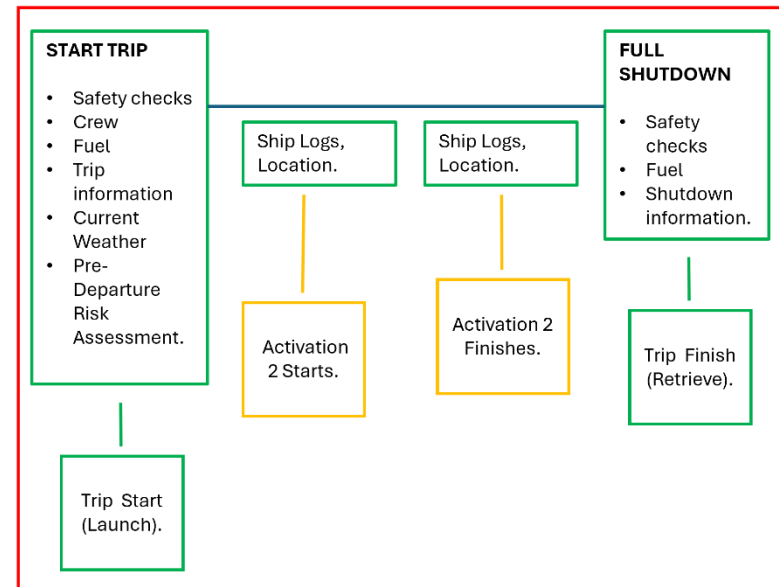


Multiple activations per day with full start up and full shut down for each trip (e.g. Call Out).



This process is repeated through out the day for each activation.

Note: Crew are removed from each trip automatically by finishing the trip. This starts and stops their sea time automatically.



These steps completed in **OffshoreSMS**

These steps completed in **Activate MRQ**. The Activation/s can be completed/finalised at the end of the day or after Full Shutdown.

Appendix 4

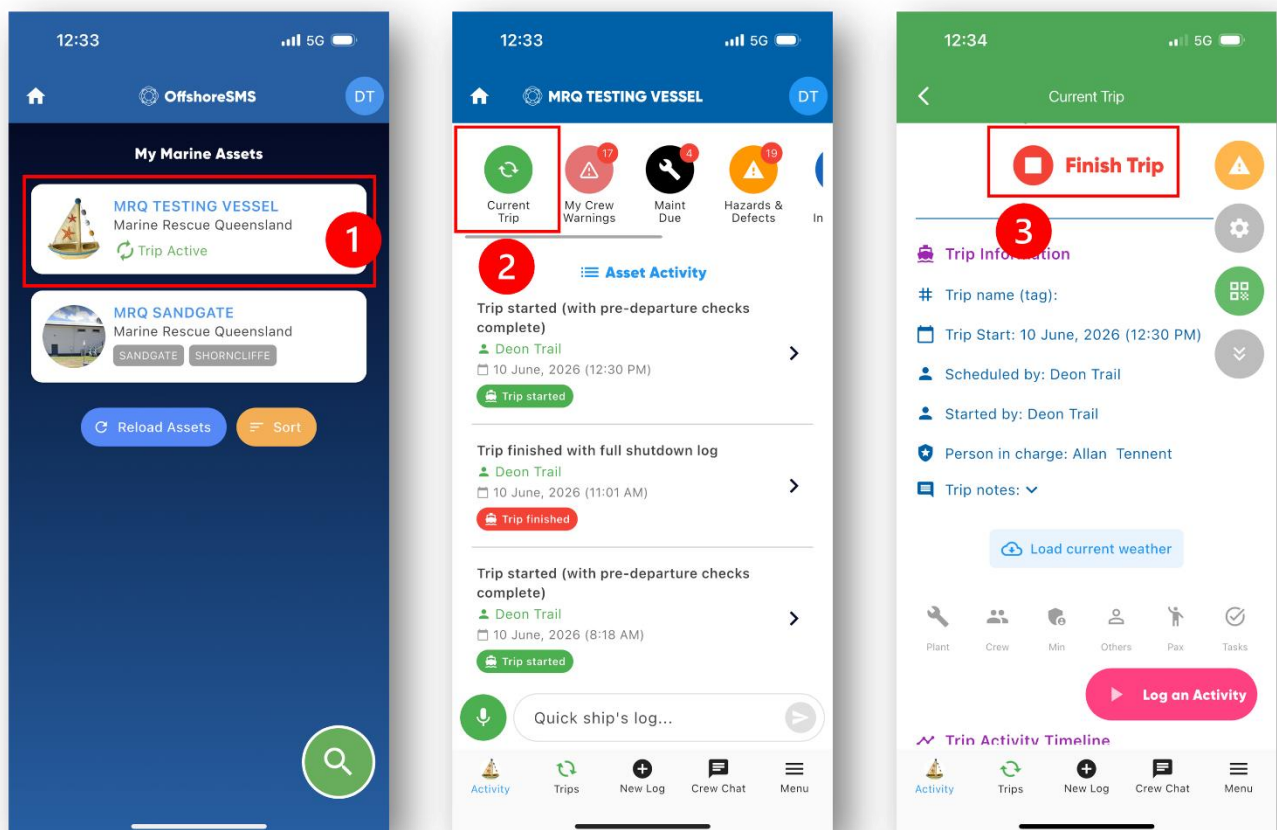
Trip Shutdown

KEY POINTS: Just as it's essential to conduct Start Up checks before departure, it's equally important to complete your trip with Shutdown checks. In OffshoreSMS, these checks are referred to as a Shutdown Log.

RESPONSIBILITY: This should be done once the vessel is berthed and your responsibilities as the Master for the operation are finished.

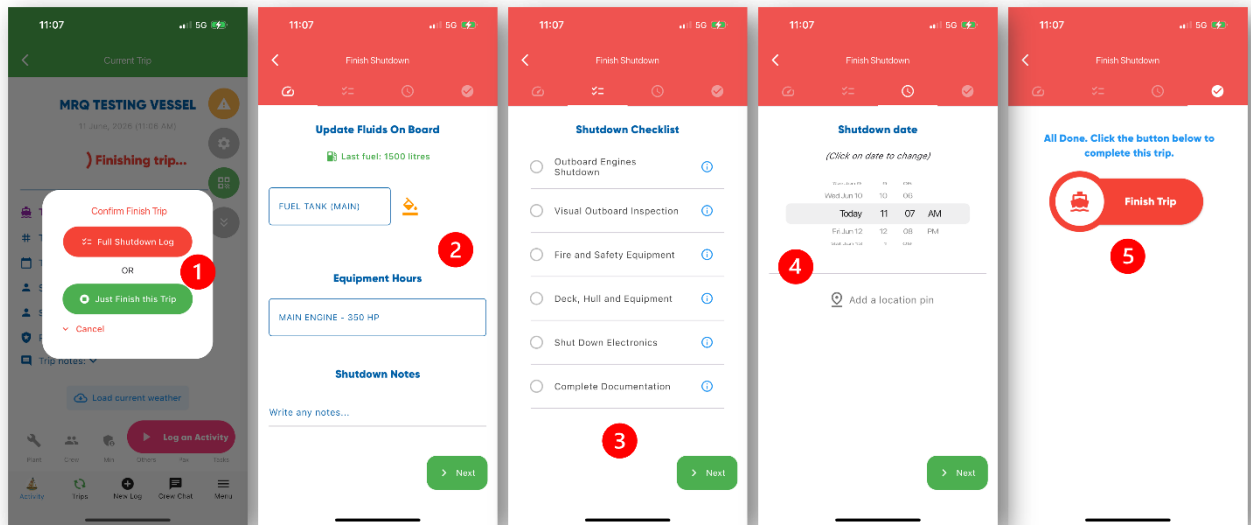
NAVIGATION

1. Vessel (Trip Active) >> Current Trip >> Finish Trip



PROCESS FLOW (The screenshots below are from a mobile phone, there may be a slight difference if they are accessed via a tablet styled device).

STEPS



1. Click on the **Full Shutdown Log** button
2. Enter the **current fuel** onboard the vessel and add any **relevant notes** regarding the trip.
3. In the shutdown checklist, click on the **+** icon beside the items that have been checked (it will change to a tick icon).
4. Confirm the shutdown **date and time**.
5. Click on the **Finish Trip** button.

Appendix 5

Edit and Finalise Activation

Steps to edit an activate (ongoing or finalised)

1. Select the ongoing activation from the list you want to edit.

The screenshot shows the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. A table titled 'All activations' lists several entries. A red rectangular box highlights the first two rows of the table, which are 'Ongoing'.

Created date & time	Activation ID	Rescue Vessel	Activation type	Status	QAS/QPS case number	Persons on board	Master	Crew
23 Jul 2026 11:32	Act-2367		Vessel Breakdown	Ongoing		2		
23 Jul 2026 11:22	Act-2366		Vessel Breakdown	Ongoing		2		
22 Jul 2026 12:42	Act-2358	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Finalised				
22 Jul 2026 12:22	Act-2357	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Finalised		4		

2. Scroll through the activation details and add or update the information as required.
3. Select the **Save** button.

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Activation' form. A red circle with the number '2' highlights the 'Distressed Vessel Information' section. A red circle with the number '3' highlights the 'Save' button.

Distressed Vessel Information

Distress Vessel Selected from Existing Database
--- Open runabout - 4.20 meters - Silver

Persons on board: 2
Is any person injured?: Select your option

Below fields will be auto populated if an existing vessel is

Steps to finalise or cancel an ongoing activation

1. Select the ongoing activation from the list you want to finalise.

The screenshot shows the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. At the top, there's a 'New Activation' button. Below it is a table of activations. A red box highlights two rows with 'Ongoing' status.

Created date & time	Activation ID	Rescue Vessel	Activation type	Status	QAS/QPS case number	Persons on board	Master	Crew
23 Jul 2026 11:32	Act-2367		Vessel Breakdown	Ongoing		2		
23 Jul 2026 11:22	Act-2366		Vessel Breakdown	Ongoing		2		
22 Jul 2026 12:42	Act-2358	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Finalised				
22 Jul 2026 12:22	Act-2357	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Finalised		4		

2. Scroll through and **confirm all the details** for the activation are correct and up to date.
3. Select the **chevron icon** in the status field (this will open a new form) and select the radio button beside **finalised** or **cancelled** depending on the situation. Once selected it will change automatically within the activation form.
4. Select the **calendar icon** in the Date & time finalised field to select the **actual** activation finish date and time, then select the **Done** button.

NOTE: Once the finalised status is selected, there will be **mandatory fields (red *)** in the form that **must be** populated before saving.

The screenshot shows the 'New Activation' form with a 'Status' modal open. Red boxes and numbers 2, 3, and 4 highlight key fields.

2 Distressed Vessel Information

3 Status: Ongoing

4 Date & time finalised

- Once the details are confirmed, the status updated and date and time entered, select the **Save** button.

The screenshot shows the 'Main Dashboard - Vessel Master' interface. A modal titled 'Edit Activation' is open, displaying various fields for updating an activation record. The 'Save' button is highlighted with a red circle and the number 5.

Modal Fields:

- Date & time Received:** 23 Jul 2026 11:32
- Date & time finalised:** 23 Jul 2026 13:25
- Status:** Finalised
- Informant Mobile:** +61 format
- Activation Source:** Radio
- Radio Channel:** VHF 73
- Distressed Vessel Information:**
 - Distress Vessel Selected from Existing Database: --- Open runabout - 4.20 meters - Silver
 - Persons on board: 2
 - Is any person injured?: Select your option

Below fields will be auto populated if an existing vessel is

Table Data:

Created date & time	Activation ID	Rescue Vessel	Activation type	Status
23 Jul 2026 11:32	Act-2367		Vessel Breakdown	On
23 Jul 2026 11:22	Act-2366		Vessel Breakdown	On
22 Jul 2026 12:42	Act-2358	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Fin
22 Jul 2026 12:22	Act-2357	MRQ MOOLOOLABA TEST VESSEL	Vessel Breakdown	Fin